



# Islamic University of Technology (IUT)

Islamiat

# **Characters**

**Islamiat (Hum 4157/4137)**



**What do you know about**  
**Charatcters????**  
**Good & Bad**

# Outline: Characters

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## ▶ Good Characters:

- ▶ Sabr/ Patience
- ▶ Sacrifice
- ▶ Justice
- ▶ Mercy
- ▶ Shyness/ Modesty
- ▶ Kindness
- ▶ Truthfulness
- ▶ Generosity
- ▶ Humbleness



# Outline: Characters

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- ▶ **Bad Characters:**

- ▶ Oppression
- ▶ Jealousy
- ▶ Cheating
- ▶ Pride



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# Good Characters

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# Good Characters

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- ▶ In Al-Qur'an:
- ▶ Allah SWT praising Rasul SM:
  - ▶ And you are certainly on the most exalted standard of **moral excellence**. (Al Qalam: 4)
- ▶ Allah SWT ordering him to maintain good manners:
  - ▶ Repel evil with what is better; then you will see that one who was once your enemy has **become your dearest friend**. (Fussilat: 34)



# Good Characters

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- ▶ Good Manners are ways to Jannah:
  - ▶ And vie with one another for your Lord's forgiveness and for a Paradise as vast as the heavens and the earth, which has been prepared for the God-fearing, for those who spend, both in prosperity and adversity, **who restrain their anger and are forgiving towards their fellow men** -- God loves those who do good works. (Al-Imran 133-134)





# Good Characters

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- ▶ In Hadith of Rasul SM:
- ▶ Rasul SM mentioning virtue of good manners:
  - ▶ Nothing will be heavier in Meezaan than good manners. (Tirmidhi)
  - ▶ Most complete Mumin is the one whose manners are the best. (Abu Dawud)
  - ▶ The most beloved among you and the most nearer from you to me in the day of judgement will be the one who has the best characters among you. (Tirmidhi)



# Good Characters

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- ▶ In sayings of **Salaf**:
- ▶ Hasan Basri says:
  - ▶ Good character is smiling,
- ▶ Abdullah bin Mubaarak says:
  - ▶ Good Character is in three qualities. Avoidance of Haraam, seeking halal and expansion upon family.





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Sabr/ Patience



# Sabr/ Patience

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- ▶ Keeping one's self steadfast upon things it dislike
- ▶ Or accepting the difficulties with kind of satisfaction
  
- ▶ Al-Qur'an:
  - ▶ Believers, be steadfast, and compete in steadfastness, stand firm in your faith, and hold Allah in fear that you may attain true success. (Aal-Imran: 200)
  - ▶ Give good news to those who are patient. Those who say, when afflicted with a calamity, "We belong to God and to Him we shall return," (Al-Baqara: 155-156)
  - ▶ We will certainly give those who are patient their reward according to the best of their actions. (An-Nahl: 96)



# Sabr/ Patience

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## ▶ Al-Hadith:

- ▶ **Mumin's matter is surprising.** All is well for him. This situation is for none but a Mumin. When he's in happy situation, he thanks Allah, so it's good for him. When he's in bad situation, he stays with patience, and that too is good for him. (Muslim)
- ▶ Allah says, "When I examine my slave with his two beloved ones (eyes), and he stays patient, I award him Jannah for these." (Bukhari)
- ▶ Whoever Allah wants good for him, examines him (by bad situations). (Bukhari)
- ▶ A Mumin has hardships in himself, his children and his wealth and this way he meets Allah without having any sin on his burden. (Tirmidhi)





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# Sacrifice





# Sacrifice

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## ► Al-Quran:

- They give them preference over themselves, even if they too are needy: those who are saved from their own souls' greed are truly successful. (Hashr: 9)
- For whatever good deed you send on before you for your souls, you will find it with Allah. It will be improved and richly rewarded by Him. (Al Muzzammil: 20)

## ► Al Hadith:

- No one among you can be a complete believer until he loves for his brother what he loves for himself.





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# Justice



# Justice

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## ▶ Al-Quran:

- ▶ Allah commands justice, kindness and giving their [due to] near relatives, and He forbids all shameful deeds, and injustice and transgression. (An-Nahl: 90)
- ▶ Allah commands you to hand back your trusts to their rightful owners, and when you judge between people, to judge with fairness. (An Nisa: 58)



# Justice

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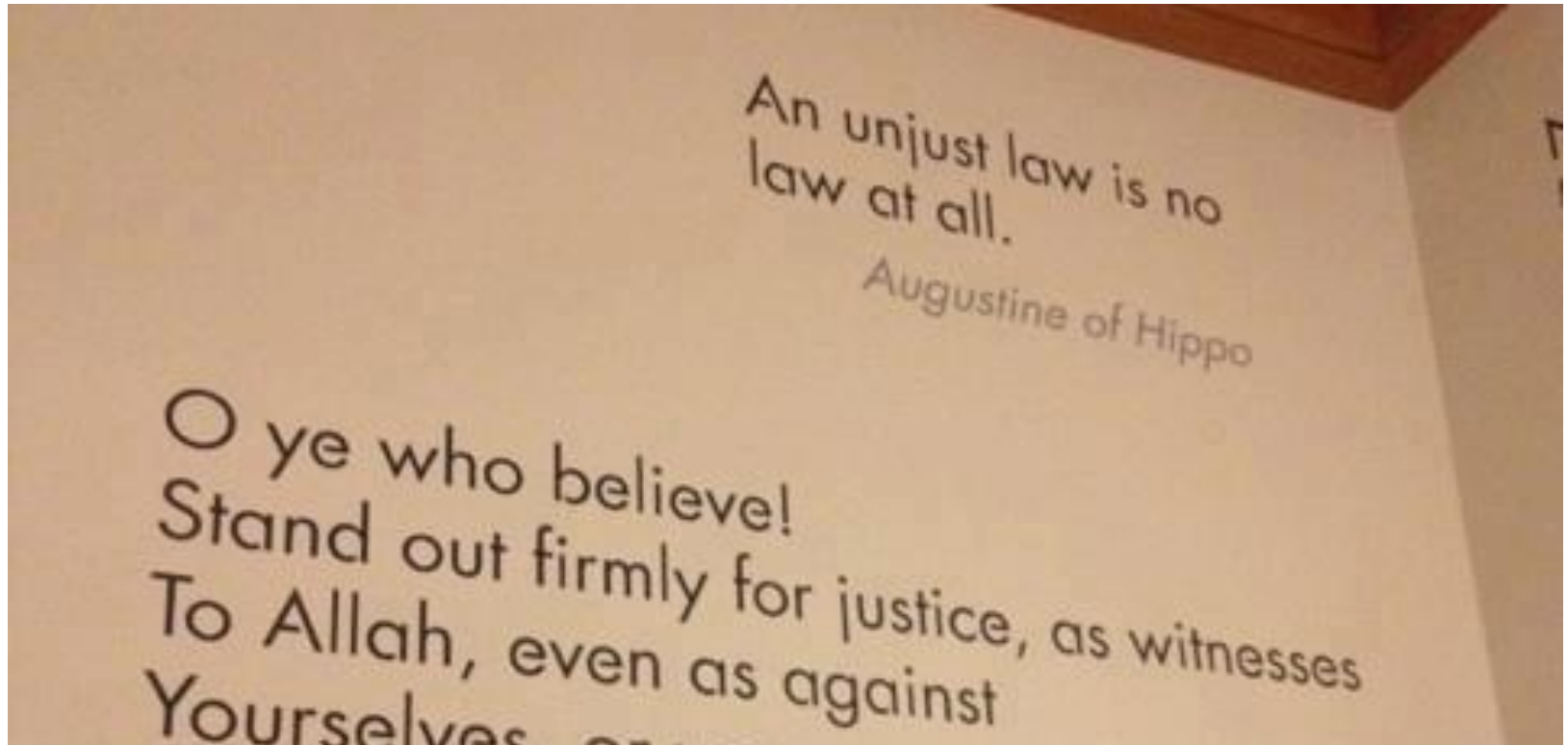
- ▶ Believers, be strict in upholding justice and bear witness for the sake of God, even though it be against yourselves, your parents, or your kindred. Be they rich or poor, God knows better about them both. Do not, then, follow your own desires, lest you swerve from justice. If you conceal the truth or evade it, then remember that God is well aware of all that you do. (An-Nisa:135)



# Justice

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## Entrance Wall of Harvard University



- ▶ <http://library.law.harvard.edu/justicequotes/explore-the-room/west>
- ▶ [http://www.muslimmirror.com/slide-news/1977-quran-verse-posted-at-entrance-wall-of-harvard-university /](http://www.muslimmirror.com/slide-news/1977-quran-verse-posted-at-entrance-wall-of-harvard-university/)



# Justice

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## ▶ Expressions of Justice:

- ▶ With Allah: Don't do shirk, obey and don't disobey
- ▶ **Judging between people: Give everyone their proper rights.**
- ▶ Between wives and children: Don't give preference to anyone over anyone else.
- ▶ In sayings: Don't give false evidence. Don't speak lie.
- ▶ In beliefs: Don't belief except what is true.







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# Mercy



# Mercy

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- ▶ **Mercy**

- ▶ Forgiving, helping, Feeding, loving etc.

- ▶ **Al-Quran:**

- ▶ Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah. Those who are with him are firm and unyielding towards those who deny the truth, but compassionate towards one another. (Al Fath: 29)



# Mercy

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## ▶ Al-Hadith:

- ▶ Be compassionate towards who is in the earth, so the one who is in the sky will be merciful. (Baihaqi)
- ▶ The believers in their mutual kindness, compassion and sympathy are just like one body. When one of the limbs suffers, the whole body responds to it with wakefulness and fever". [Al-Bukhari and Muslim].
- ▶ When I start the prayer I intend to prolong it, but on hearing the cries of a child, I cut short the prayer because I know that the cries of the child will incite its mother's passions. [Bukhari]



# Mercy

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- ▶ A man felt very thirsty while he was on the way, there he came across a well. He went down the well, quenched his thirst and came out. Meanwhile he saw a dog panting and licking mud because of excessive thirst. He said to himself, "This dog is suffering from thirst as I did." So, he went down the well again and filled his shoe with water and watered it. Allah thanked him for that deed and forgave him. --The people said, "O Allah's Apostle! Is there a reward for us in serving the animals?" He replied: "Yes, there is a reward for serving any animate (living being). [Bukhari]





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Shyness / Modesty



# Shyness/ Modesty

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- ▶ Shyness from disobeying Allah or doing sin, not in obeying Allah or doing a good work or telling a truth.
- ▶ Al-Hadith:
  - ▶ Faith has over seventy branches or over sixty branches, the most excellent of which is the declaration that there is no god but Allah, and the humblest of which is the, removal of what is injurious from the path: and modesty is the branch of faith.  
[Muslim]







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# Truthfulness



# Truthfulness

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## ▶ Al-Qur'an:

- ▶ Believers, fear God and stand with the truthful. (At-Tawba: 119)

## ▶ Al-Hadith:

- ▶ It is obligatory for you to tell the truth, for truth leads to virtue and virtue leads to Paradise, and the man who continues to speak the truth and endeavours to tell the truth is eventually recorded as truthful with Allah, and beware of telling of a lie for telling of a lie leads to obscenity and obscenity leads to Hell-Fire, and the person who keeps telling lies and endeavours to tell a lie is recorded as a liar with Allah. [Muslim]



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- ▶ "Give up what is doubtful to you for that which is not doubtful; for truth is peace of mind and falsehood is doubt". [At-Tirmidhi].



# Truthfulness

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- ▶ **Expressions:**

- ▶ In sayings
- ▶ In transactions
- ▶ In planning
- ▶ In promises
- ▶ In his situations





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# Generosity



# Generosity

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- ▶ Opposite of miserliness
- ▶ Al-Quran:
  - ▶ Verily man is impatient by nature: when misfortune touches him he starts lamenting, and whenever good fortune comes to him, he grows niggardly. except those that pray, and are constant in their Prayer; [Al-Ma'arij: 19-25]
  - ▶ And spend out of what We have provided you with before death comes to one of you and he says, "My Lord! If only You would grant me respite for a little while, then I would give alms and be among the righteous." [Munafiqun: 10]



# Generosity

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- ▶ **Al-Hadith:**

- ▶ There is no envy except in two: a person whom Allah has given wealth and he spends it in the right way, and a person whom Allah has given wisdom (i.e. religious knowledge) and he gives his decisions accordingly and teaches it to the others. [Bukhari]







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# Humbleness



# Humbleness

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- ▶ Opposite of Pride
- ▶ Al-Qur'an:
  - ▶ And be humble to the believers who follow you. [Ash-Shuaraa: 215]
  - ▶ As for the abode of the Hereafter, We shall assign it to those who seek neither self-aggrandisement on the earth nor corruption. The righteous shall have a blessed end. [Al-Qasas: 83]



# Humbleness

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## ▶ Al-Hadith:

- ▶ The proud will be gathered on the Day of Judgement resembling tiny particles in the image of men. They will be covered with humiliation everywhere, they will be dragged into a prison in Hell called Bulas, submerged in the Fire of Fires, drinking the drippings of the people of the Fire, filled with derangement. [Tirmidhi]
- ▶ Allah has revealed to me that you should humble yourselves to one another. One should neither hold himself above another nor transgress against another. [Muslim]
- ▶ Every Prophet has tended sheep". He was asked: "And did you?" He replied, "Yes, I tended them for a few carats for the Makkans." [Al-Bukhari]





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# Dispraised characters



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Dhulm/ Oppression



# Dhulm/ Oppression

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## ▶ Al-Qur'an:

- ▶ Do no wrong, and no wrong will be done to you. [Al-Baqara: 279]

## ▶ Al-Hadith:

- ▶ He who usurps even a span of land would be made to wear around his neck seven earths. [Bukhari-Muslim]
  - ▶ **Whoever has wronged his brother, should ask for his pardon (before his death), as (in the Hereafter) there will be neither a Dinar nor a Dirham. (He should secure pardon in this life) before some of his good deeds are taken and paid to his brother, or, if he has done no good deeds, some of the bad deeds of his brother are taken to be loaded on him (in the Hereafter). [Bukhari]**
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# Dhulm/ Oppression

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- ▶ Whoever cuts off the right of a muslim man by his oath, Allah forbids him the Garden and obliges the Fire for him." They said, "Even if it is something insignificant, Messenger of Allah?" He said, "Even if it is a tooth-stick, even if it is a tooth- stick," repeating it three times. [Muatta Malik]
- ▶ All things of a Muslim are inviolable for his brother in faith: his blood, his wealth and his honour. [Muslim]





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# Jealousy/ Hasad



# Jealousy/ Hasad

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- ▶ Opposite of: Seeking good and sacrificing for others
- ▶ Al-Qur'an:
  - ▶ Do they envy others for the bounty that Allah has bestowed upon them? [An-Nisa: 51]
- ▶ 2 types:
  - ▶ Wish to demise blessing from others, and wish to have it for self
  - ▶ Wish to demise blessing from others, without wishing to have for self – This is worse
  - ▶ **Ghibtah** – Wish to have blessing like others have – without demising from them. – permitted



# Jealousy/ Hasad

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- ▶ Avoid envy, for envy devours good deeds just as fire devours fuel or (he said) "grass." [Abu Dawud]





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# Cheating/ Ghash



# Cheating/ Ghash

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- ▶ Whoever has the following four (characteristics) will be a pure hypocrite and whoever has one of the following four characteristics will have one characteristic of hypocrisy unless and until he gives it up.
  1. Whenever he is entrusted, he betrays.
  2. Whenever he speaks, he tells a lie.
  3. Whenever he makes a covenant, he proves treacherous.
  4. Whenever he quarrels, he behaves in a very imprudent, evil and insulting manner. [Bukhari]





# Cheating/ Ghash

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- ▶ The Messenger of Allah (saws) passed by a pile of food. He put his fingers in it and felt wetness. He said: 'O owner of the food! What is this ?' He replied: 'It was rained upon O Messenger of Allah.' He said: 'Why not put it on top of the food so the people can see it?' Then he said: 'Whoever cheats, he is not one of us.'" [Tirmidhi]



# Summary

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## ▶ Good Characters:

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- ▶ Sacrifice
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## ▶ Bad Characters:

- ▶ Oppression
- ▶ Jealousy
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- ▶ Pride



# Reference

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- ▶ Reference book:

- ▶ Jabir al-Jazairi, Abu Bakar, (2001), **Minhaj Al-Muslim: A Book of Creed, Manners, Character, Acts of Worship and Other Deeds**, Riyadh, Dar-Us-Salam Publications.

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مع السلامة  
**Thanks**

